



strategy in T20 cricket and an apparent obduracy of the think tank when it comes to certain selection calls, but the one-step-forward, two-steps-back dance in the shortest format has been a feature of Indian cricket for a while. That being said, Rohit and Kohli are perhaps batting as well as they have ever batted in ODI cricket, and hopefully, they will carry that form to the Caribbean islands should they make the cut eventually.

Meanwhile, India Women will also bid for their maiden T20 World Cup trophy when the 2024 edition takes place in Bangladesh in September and October. India has many new players and a new coach in Amol Muzumdar, and while the England and Australia series at home were ideal preparations, the results were anything but. India lost the T20 series to England 1-2 at home, its sixth successive series defeat against the Three Lions in the format.

A new hope: It seems likely that both Rohit and Kohli will be part of the 2024 World Cup after the duo was named in the squad for the Afghanistan T20I series at home, ending their more than year-long absence from the shortest format. K. R. DEEPAK

Harmanpreet's side was then humbled by Alyssa Healy's Australia by a similar margin in a three-match T20I series.

That said, the emergence of the Women's Premier League, the revival of the 'A' system, and a focus on the Under-19s have given the women's T20 game a much-needed fillip. The fact that uncapped Indians, Kashvee Gautam and Vrinda Dinesh, attracted bids of Rs 2 crore (Gujarat Giants) and Rs 1.3 crore (UP Warriorz), respectively, at the WPL auction in Mumbai is a testament to the burgeoning talent pool in Indian women's cricket and an evolving but



Highlights of 2023 Men

Reached the final of ODI World Cup, winning **10 matches** on the trot

Reached a second successive World Test Championship final
Won gold at Asian Games

Women

Made history with its first Test win over Australia

Won gold at Asian Games